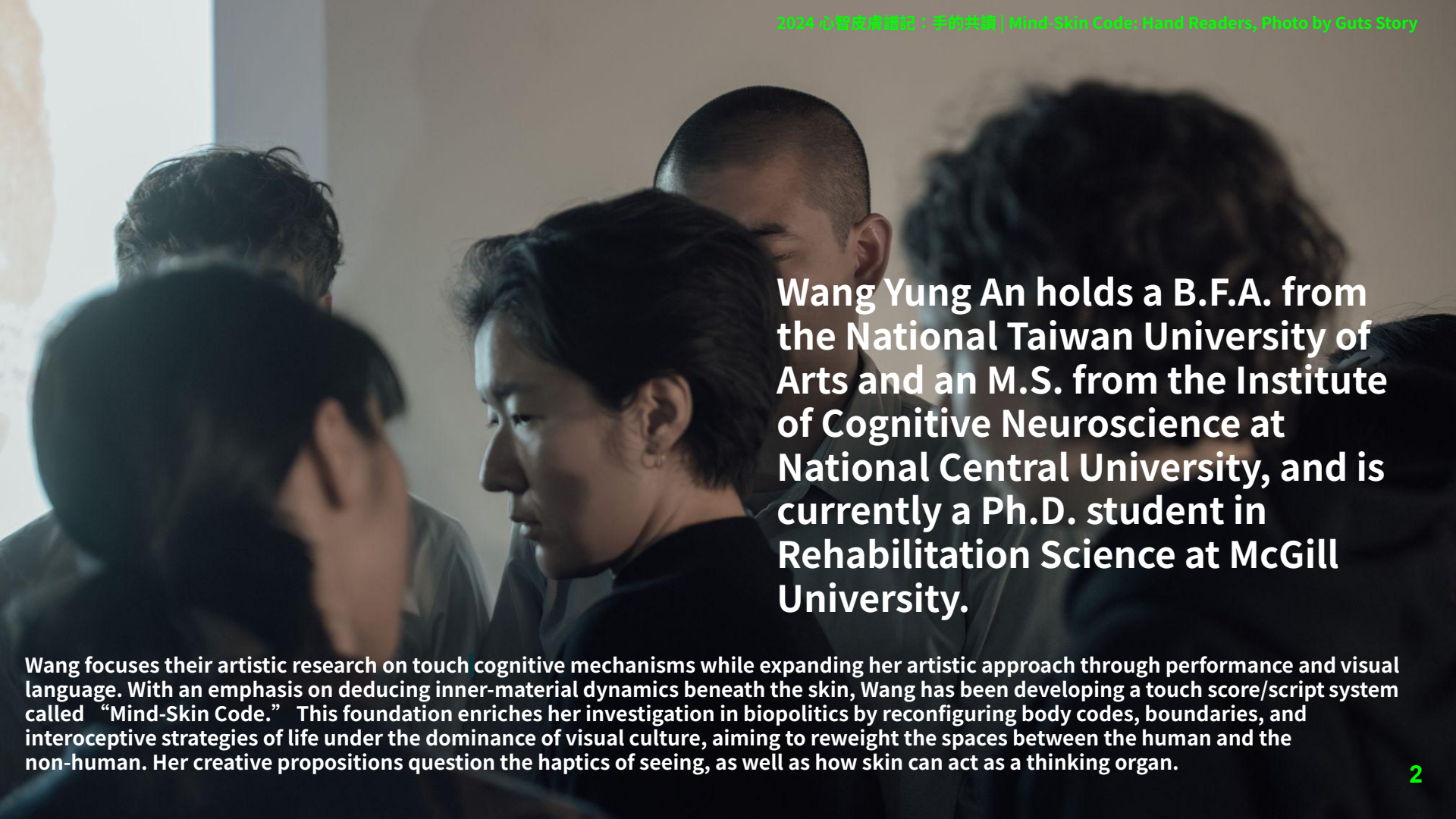


王 永 安

Wang Yung An
Portfolio 2026



Wang Yung An holds a B.F.A. from the National Taiwan University of Arts and an M.S. from the Institute of Cognitive Neuroscience at National Central University, and is currently a Ph.D. student in Rehabilitation Science at McGill University.

Wang focuses their artistic research on touch cognitive mechanisms while expanding her artistic approach through performance and visual language. With an emphasis on deducing inner-material dynamics beneath the skin, Wang has been developing a touch score/script system called “Mind-Skin Code.” This foundation enriches her investigation in biopolitics by reconfiguring body codes, boundaries, and interoceptive strategies of life under the dominance of visual culture, aiming to reweight the spaces between the human and the non-human. Her creative propositions question the haptics of seeing, as well as how skin can act as a thinking organ.

Selected Works and Activities in Recent Years:

- **2024 - 2026 *Skin Archaeology: Ghost Variables***, Dance Essay Film and Installation, Exhibited at: NCPI, Taiwan (2026); Gyeonggi Museum of Modern Art, South Korea (2025); Kaohsiung Museum of Fine Arts, Taiwan (2024). – Artist
- **2025 *Skin Archaeology: P300 Skin Ship***, Multimedia Installation, Commissioned by MoCA Taipei – Artist
- **2023 *Ghost Skin***, Theatrical Performance, Guling Street Avant-Garde Theatre – Director
- **2022 *Asymmetric Utopia***, Immersive web-based software, commissioned by ITRI Artist-in-Residence Program – Director and Artist
- **2020 *Human Fabric Trilogy***: The Haptics of Seeing I–III, Performances & Mixed Media Installation, Taipei & Tainan, Taiwan

Recent Workshops, Academic Presentations, and Talks:

- **2022 - 2025** Delivered lectures at National Taiwan University of Arts, National Sun Yat-sen University, Shih Chien University, National Tsing Hua University, Taipei National University of the Arts, Kaohsiung Museum of Fine Arts, and the Museum of Contemporary Art in Chile
- **2022 - 2025** Led multiple Mind-Skin Code workshops in Thailand, South Korea, Chile, and Taiwan
- **2023** Presented a conference paper at a Organization for Human Brain Mapping



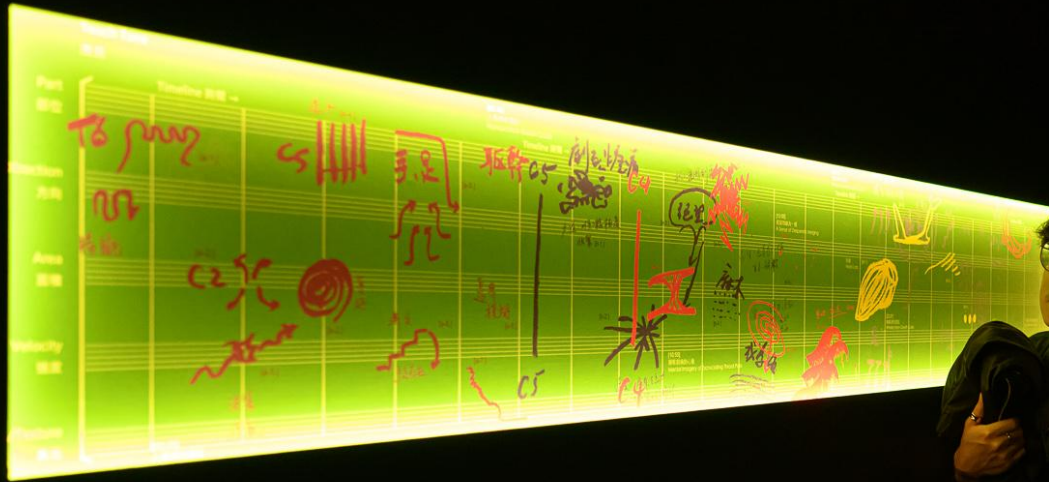
2025 Skin Archaeology: P300 Skin Ship 《皮膚考：P300膚感方舟》
@Taipei MoCA With Collaborative project with Skin Sensing Space (SSS) 4



Multimedia Interactive Installation ([Sound Theater](#), [Transcript](#)), variable dimensions.

This work takes “the dying process of species” as the starting point of its science fiction narrative. Through a docufictional oral narrative approach, it focuses on the physical changes in the tactile sense of land creatures that have migrated to the deep sea, speculating on the impact that the drastic habitat change has on the species’ physiological perceptions.

human narratives,
senses,
ethics of
"r-death"
daries of sensory



The foundation of the narrative lies in the Mind-Skin Code—a haptic-based system of recording and communication proposed by the artist to capture physiopscho sensory imprints and translate them into a shared haptic landscape. The work further constructs the image of an ark, serving as a poetic vessel where human electrophysiological responses intertwine with the pain sensations of multiple species.

[Mind-Skin Code Fieldwork Audio Recording, Transcript](#)



2024 Skin Archaeology: Ghost Variables 《皮膚考：幽靈變數》

2026@National Center of Photography and Images, Taipei



2024 Skin Archaeology: Ghost Variables 《皮膚考：幽靈變數》

2025@Gyeonggi Museum of Modern Art, South Korea



2024 Skin Archaeology: Ghost Variables 《皮膚考：幽靈變數》

2024@Kaohsiung Museum of Fine Arts, Taiwan

"Does artificial intelligence have skin?" As the human body and computational world intertwine, self-perception blurs with collective data. Sensory experiences, if untranslated, become "ghost variables"—irrelevant in computation. Through neuroscience and touch research, the artist uses neuroimaging from affective touch and dance films to explore marginalized bodily forms in human-computer interfaces, reimagining movements under computational logic.

This film was inspired by the artist's neuroscientific research titled 'The Changes in EEG Theta Oscillation Induced by Affective Touch: Comparing Brush Stroke, Hand Stroke, and Massage-like Tapping,' conducted at the Human Memory Lab at NCU and the Brain and Learning Lab at NYCU in Taiwan.

I wonder if it's because

Two-channel video installation, HD Color (Sound), 13' 59' "

Director / Script / Choreography / Mind-Skin Code / Performance: Wang Yung-An

Shooting: Dina Karaman

Editing: Dina Karaman, Wang Yung-An

Voices: Wang Yung-An, Eleven Multilingual v2 model

Sound Mixing: Lu Chih Hao

Special Thanks: JR Duann, Esther Lu

皮膚，
以視覺的方式被人知
知，只有百分之二
自於你的眼睛，其餘
來自你大腦的觸覺

"**Ghost Skin**" explores touch as a ghost-like presence—fundamental yet often overlooked among the senses. In an era dominated by artificial intelligence, can we expand communication to embrace the cultural possibilities of interspecies and cross-consciousness connections, or will we fall back into anthropocentrism?



Artist **Wang Yung-An's Mind-Skin Code** methodology, develops ways to communicate and interpret through touch. Adapting the format of a lecture performance within a theatrical context, this work blurs the boundaries between performance and visual art, rehearsing a future of human-machine empathy.

Lecture Performance in a Theater Setting

Director / Script / Choreography / Mind-Skin Code: Wang Yung-An

Script Collaboration: Chen Chia-Yi

Performance: Liu Ting-Yu, Chung Chang-Hung

Production: Idea Theater

2023 Ghost Skin 《鬼皮膚》 13



邦托鳥樓歪

2022 Asymmetric Utopia

Interview in ITRI - 5' 48
Documentary Video

ASYMMETRIC UTOPIA



An immersive performance integrating software development:

1. Recording Parts of The Work
2. Participatory Music Generated from Audience

Story 1: [Enlightenment Buddhist Temple](#)
Story 2: [Bao'an Pharmacy \(The Masseur\)](#)
Story 3: [Oolong Monastery](#)
Story 4: [Fuwen Park](#)
Story 5: [Lee Ko-Yung Library](#)
Final Story: [Flying Lotus Massage Parlor](#)

[Complete Story Transcript](#)



The quilt did gets out of the bridge - Sound Material
The quilt did not gets out of the bridge - Sound Material

Musical Material, Web Info

2021 The Quilt Gets Out of The Bridge While Su Yi-Shi Is...

18



Human Fabric Trilogy

2020 The Haptics of Seeing III - Theater Performance

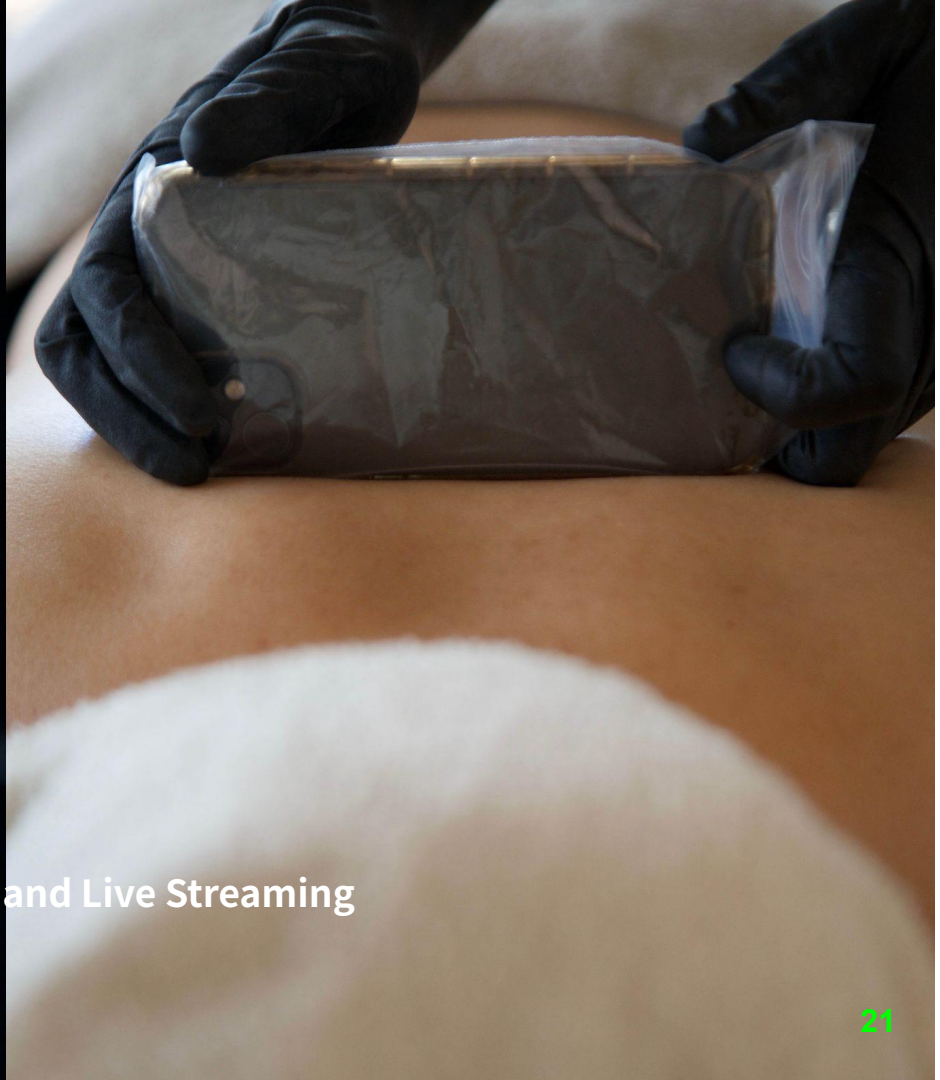
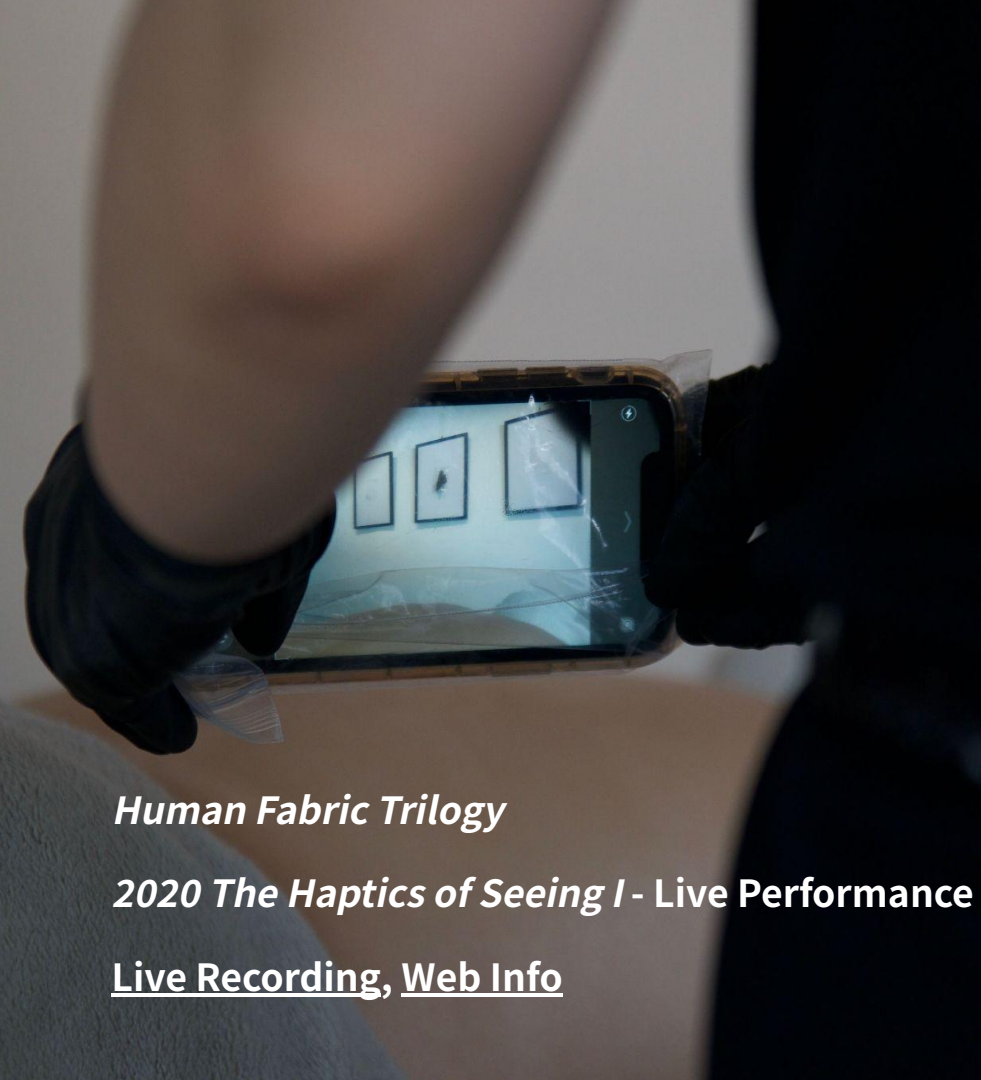
[Video 1](#), [Video 2](#), [Video 3](#), [Web Info](#)



Human Fabric Trilogy

2020 The Haptics of Seeing II - Participatory and Installation

Film, Web Info



Human Fabric Trilogy

2020 The Haptics of Seeing I - Live Performance and Live Streaming

[Live Recording](#), [Web Info](#)



Research 研究



Master Research
Thesis:

The Changes in EEG
Theta Oscillation
Induced by Affective
Touch: Comparing
Brush Stroke, Hand
Stroke, and
Massage-like Tapping.

Photo: Ren Yu 23



The Changes in EEG Theta Oscillation Induced by Affective Touch: Comparing Brush Stroke, Hand Stroke, and Massage-like Tapping

Yung-An Wang¹, Jeng-Ren Duann^{2,3}

[1] Institute of Cognitive Neuroscience, National Central University, Zhongli, Taoyuan, Taiwan
[2] Institute of Education, National Yang Ming Chiao Tung University, Hsinchu City, Hsinchu, Taiwan
[3] Institute for Neural Computation, University of California San Diego, La Jolla, CA USA

Introduction

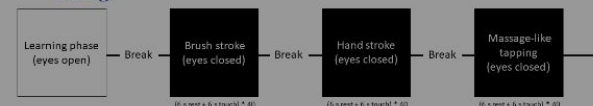
- Affective touch [4] has typically been defined as a slow, gentle, and low-force **brush touch** and discernable by the dual pathway of slow unmyelinated CT afferent and fast myelinated A-beta afferent.
- Recent evidence [1] has challenged the 'dual pathway' model in differentiating affective properties in affective touch, by comparing pleasure level of cordotomy subjects.
- The neural mechanism of the **social touch** and **massage** [3], which are the interaction among multisensory systems and a major touch experience in our daily life under social context, is still not well investigated.
- In this study, we designed an EEG tactile experiment [2] with three types of touch stimuli, namely brush stroke, hand stroke and massage-like tapping, applied at CT optimal (5 cm/s) and CT suboptimal (18 cm/s) velocity. The aims of this study are to find (1) **which EEG channels manifested significant oscillatory changes before and after touch stimuli**, (2) **if EEG oscillations were altered by different touch styles and stimulation velocities**, and (3) **what properties of the tactile information were identified as inducing pleasure in affective touch using EEG oscillations and subjective pleasantness ratings?**

Data Analysis

- The selected band power was the statistically compared against the pleasantness ratings using a **repeated-measure two-way ANOVA**.
- Preprocessed EEG data were decomposed by **independent component analysis (ICA)**.
- The time-frequency decomposition was applied to the epoched EEG data.

Methods

- 20 healthy female volunteers participated in brush stroke, hand stroke, and massage-like tapping at two different velocities and rating tasks using EEG.
 - Mean age **28.0** years old (SD = 9.2 years old)
- Tactile stimulation:
 - The experiment consisted of blocks of **6-s resting** and **6-s tactile stimulation** with conditions of **brush stroke**, **hand stroke**, and **massage-like tapping** at **5 cm/s** and **18 cm/s**.
 - 5 ~ 15 pleasantness ratings**: -5 indicating no pleasure, 15 indicating most pleasure.
- Procedure:
 - Participants received touch stimuli during the experiment and were **trained to rate them with their eyes open**. During the experiment, they **closed their eyes** to make pleasantness rating.



- The stimulation velocities were arranged in a counterbalanced order to ensure the same stimulation types would not appear consecutively.
- In the test phase consisted of three blocks, each containing 20 CT-optimal touch trials and 20 CT-suboptimal touch trials, with velocities counterbalanced across conditions.

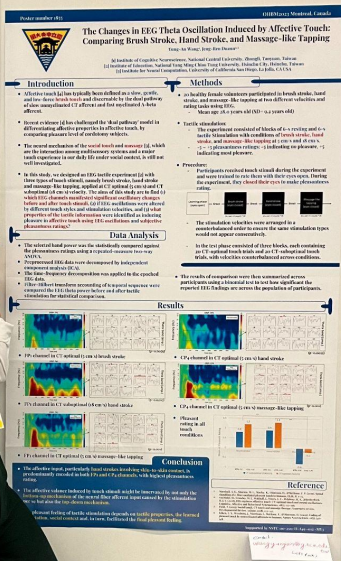
- The results of comparison were then summarized across

2023 OHBM Poster
Presentation

caudate nuclei is associated
Central Post Stroke Pain
Chang et al. (2018)



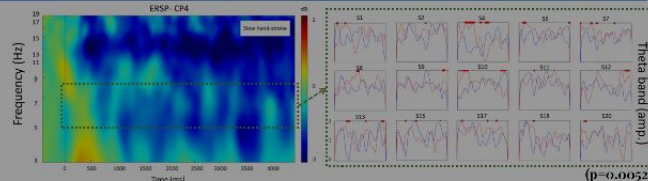
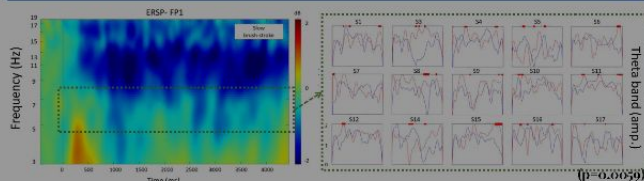
2023 OHBM Poster Presentation



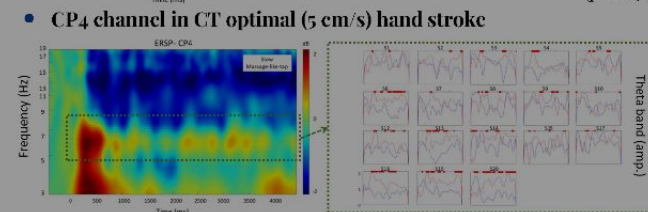
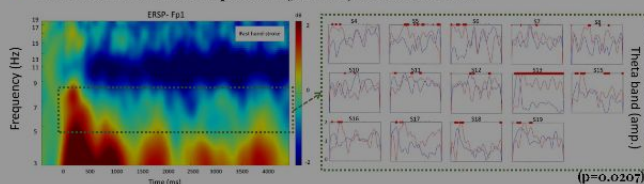
261

- EEG data.
- Filter-Hilbert transform accounting of temporal sequence were compared the EEG theta power before and after tactile stimulation for statistical comparison.

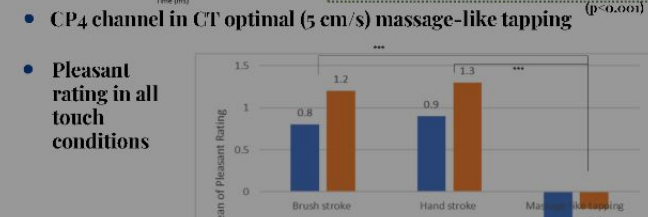
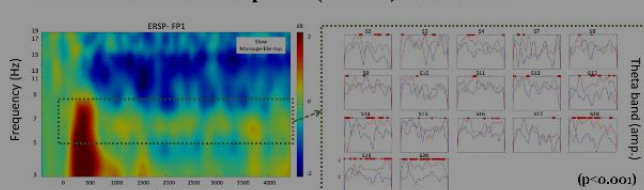
Results



- FP1 channel in CT optimal (5 cm/s) brush stroke

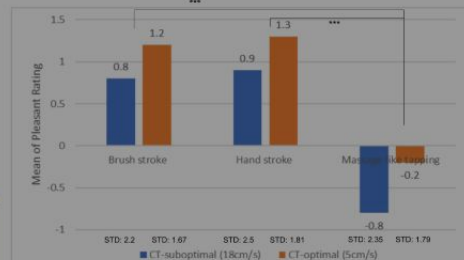


- FP1 channel in CT suboptimal (18 cm/s) hand stroke



- FP1 channel in CT optimal (5 cm/s) massage-like tapping

- Pleasant rating in all touch conditions



Conclusion

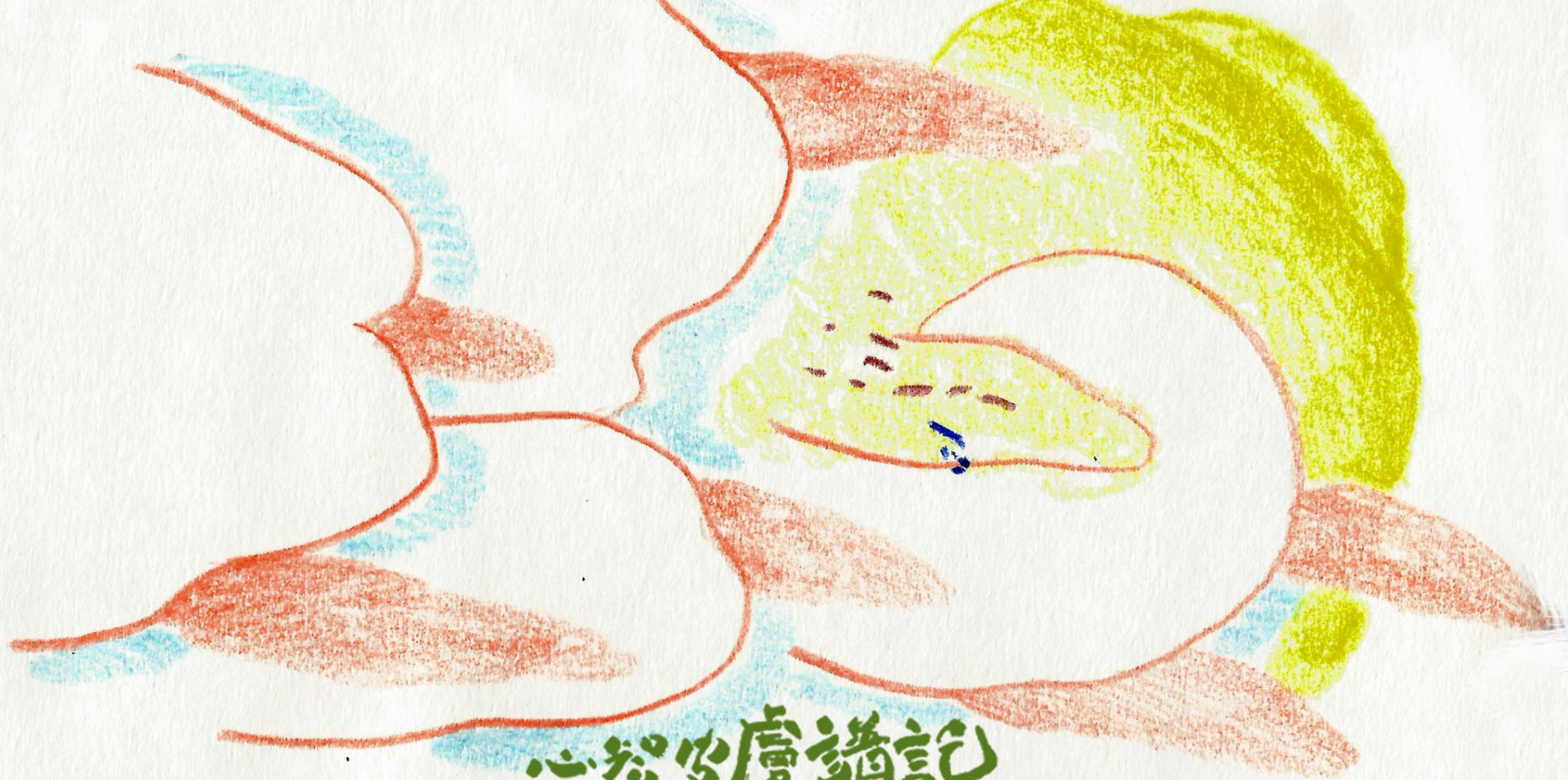
- The affective input, particularly **hand strokes involving skin-to-skin contact**, is predominantly encoded in both **FP1 and CP4 channels**, with highest pleasantness rating.
- The affective valence induced by touch stimuli might be innervated by not only the **bottom-up mechanism** of the neural fiber afferent input caused by the stimulation per se but also the **top-down mechanism**.
- The pleasant feeling of tactile stimulation depends on **tactile properties, the learned expectation, social context** and, in turn, facilitated the **final pleasant feeling**.

Reference

1. Marshall, A. G., Sharma, M. L., Marley, K., Olsson, H., & McGlone, F. P. (2019). Spinal signalling of e-fiber mediated pleasant touch in humans. *ELife*, 8, 1-15.
2. von Mohr, M., Crowley, M. J., Wathall, J., Mares, L. C., Pelly, K. A., & Butterfield, H. J. V. (2018). EEG captures affective touch: CT-optimal touch and neural oscillations. *Cognitive, Affective and Behavioral Neuroscience*, 18(1), 155-166.
3. Field, T. (2019). Social touch, CT touch and massage therapy: A narrative review. *Developmental Review*, 51(June 2018), 123-145.
4. Löken, L. S., Wessberg, J., Morrison, I., McGlone, F., & Olsson, H. (2009). Coding of pleasant touch by unmyelinated afferents in humans. *Nature Neuroscience*, 12(9), 947-948.

Research-based Workshop

研究型
工作坊



心智皮膚譜記
Mind-Skin Code

Mind-Skin Code: A tactile documentation method inspired by signal processing and cognitive neuroscience research methodologies.

Skin Cards: Illustrated cards used for recording tactile experiences.

Affective Model Analysis (VAD): Presentation of digital and embodied gaze perspectives through a Valence-Arousal-Dominance emotional model.

Mind-Skin Code Structure

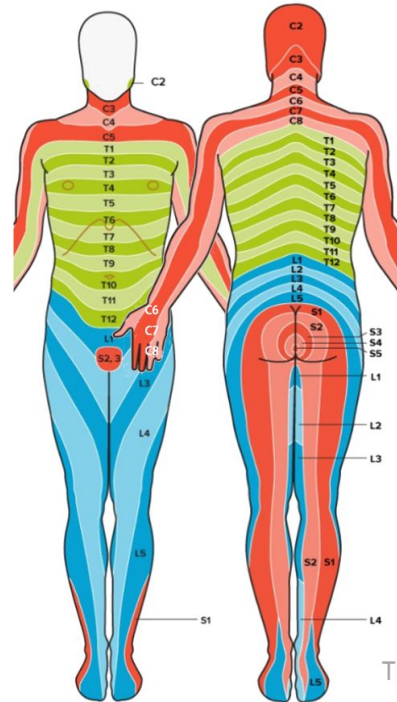
Mind-Skin Code

心智皮膚編譜

Mind-Skin Code

Touch Tone

觸調



Pressure

力道

Direction

方向

Area

面積

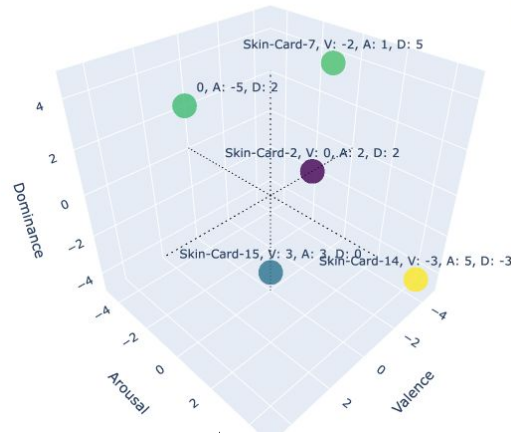
Velocity

速度

Trait/Texture

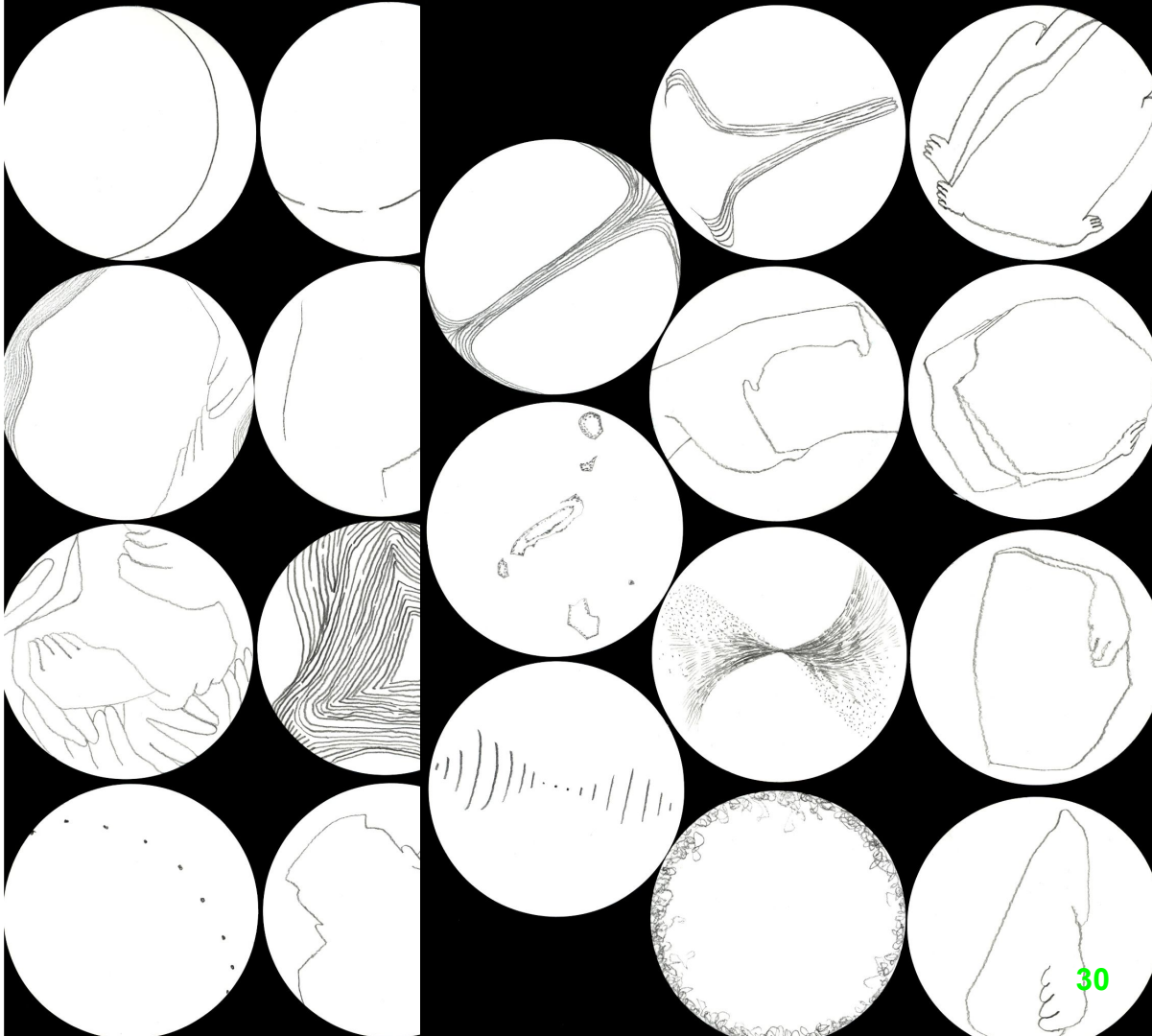
質地

Timeline 時間 →



Mind-Skin Code integrates a quantitative affective model to facilitate cross-sensory thinking through tactile skin cards, and incorporates sound design (English) for practicing tactile gestures.

Ima
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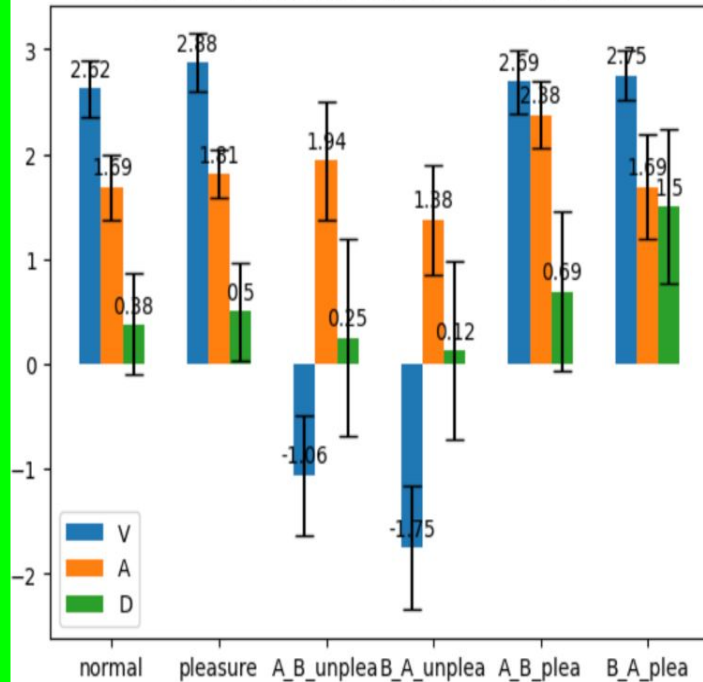


legend()

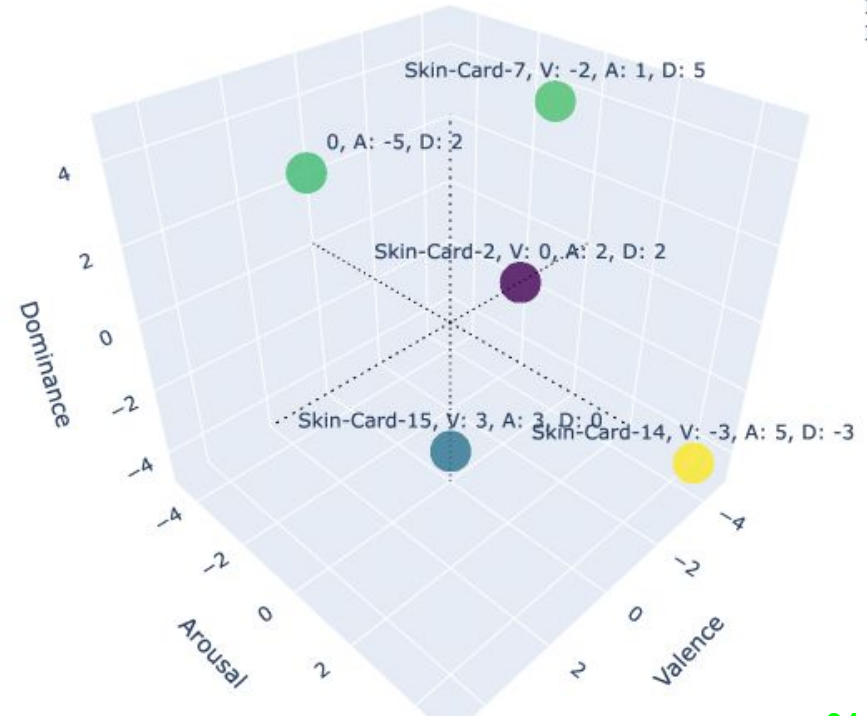
Data Modeling and Analysis

show()

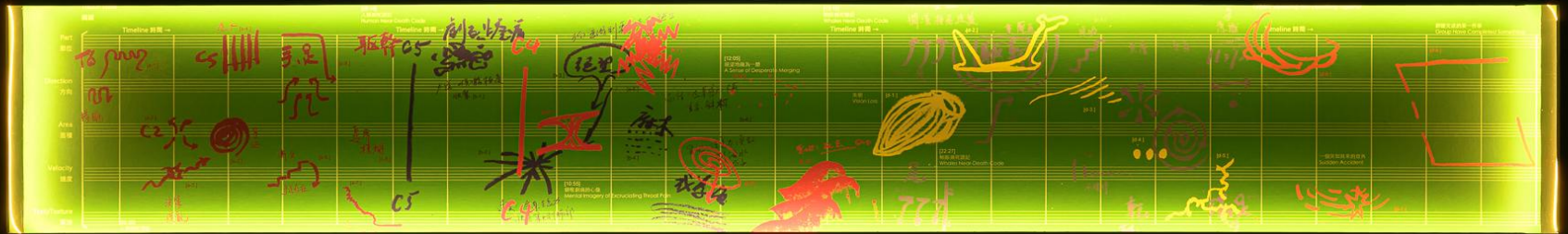
Scores by handshake type and VAD with SEM



Mind-Skin Code: Hand Readers Affective Evaluation - VAD

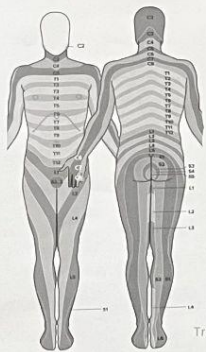


```
import numpy as np
import pandas as pd
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
```

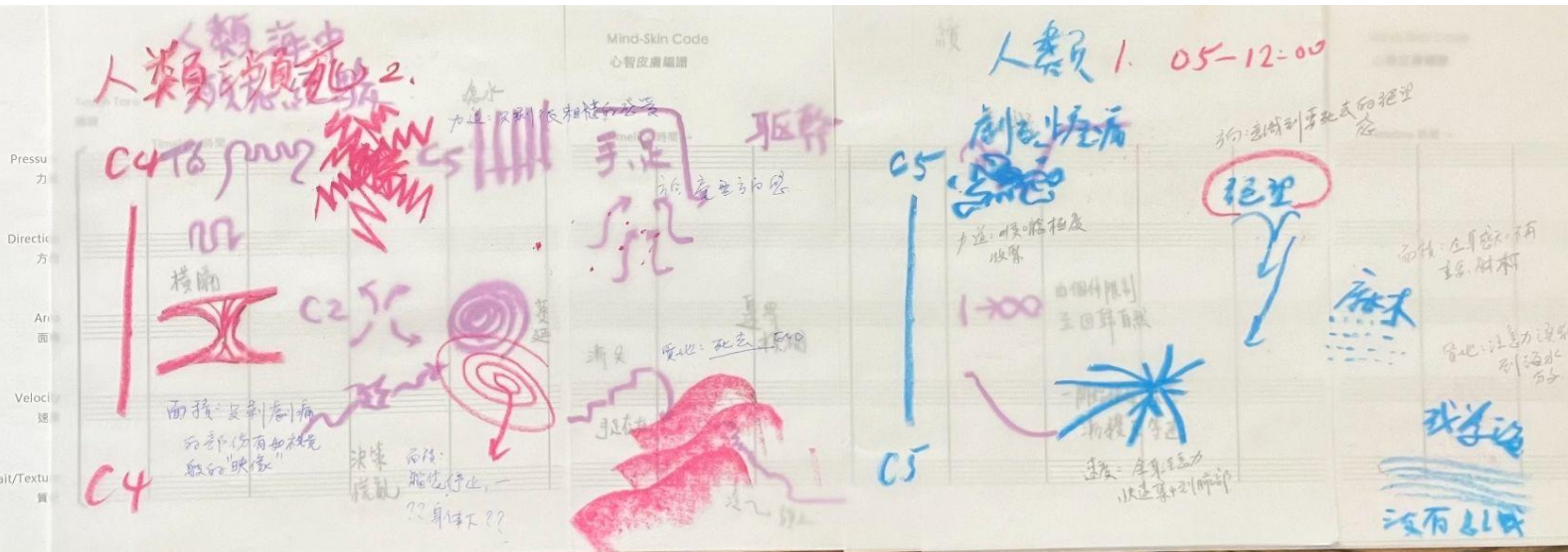


Mind-Skin Code as Ethnographic Cartography

Mind-Skin Code Fieldwork Audio Recording, Transcript



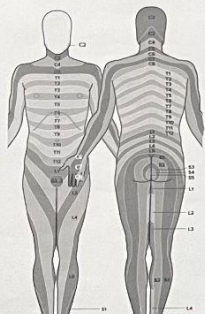
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Not a Dermatologist from MedicalNewsToday



Mind-Skin Code as Ethnographic Cartography – A Joint Mapping by Artist and Scientist

Mind-Skin Code

心智皮膚編譜



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Vet Dermatologist from MedicalNewsToday

Pressure
力道

Direction
方向

Area
面積

Velocity
速度

Trait/Texture
質地



前頸: 全身脫水

白色, 搖晃, 低影, 高明亮 – 感知 信息 Mind-Skin Code

心智皮膚編譜

Touch Tone
觸音

Timeline 時間 →

力道: 擠在背部的腺體

溫度: 和環境

暖傷而趨寒

Timeline 時間 →

方向: 流過材料

力道: 擠在背部的腺體

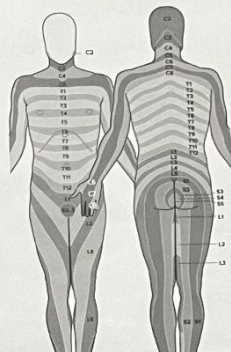


氣血
因氣血
失調而
產生變化

前、面、背、腹: 身體中每個部位
的溫度都會被感知, 知道
因失去生命而趨寒, 但知道
這一切 (具有邊界的感知)

Mind-Skin Code

心智皮膚編譜



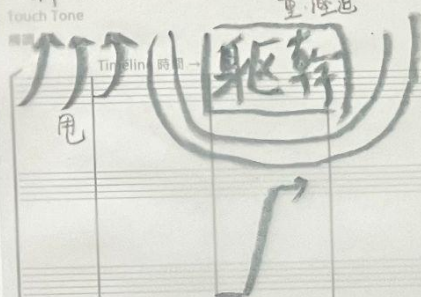
Pressure
力道

Direction
方向

Area
面積

Velocity
速度

鯨豚集體
擱淺頻度經驗



尾

重壓區

呼吸

不規律

Mind-Skin Code

心智皮膚編譜

皮膚 全身



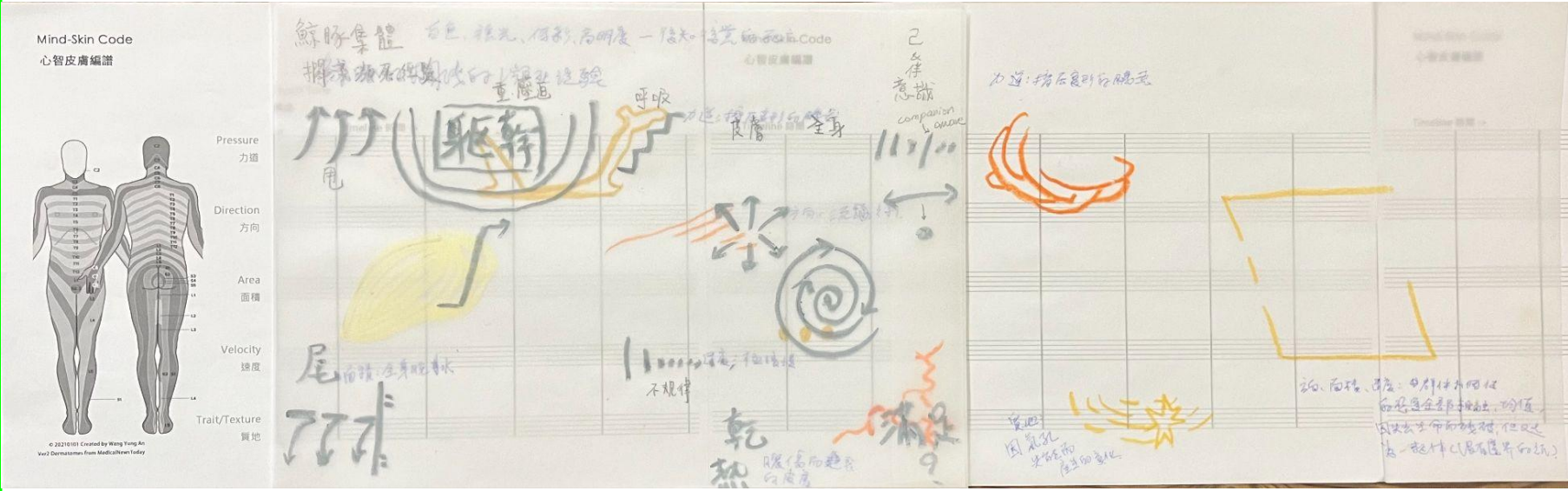
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11/2/00

↓

Mind-Skin Code as Ethnographic Cartography –



2026 “Mind-Skin Code: Tsin-tsiànn sī sng-thiànn”
Guling Street Avant-garde Theatre, Taipei

AT - 心智皮膚譜記 MIND-SKIN CODE

Photo Documentation of the Event

AT - 心智皮膚譜記 MIND-SKIN CODE



Workshop Records Over the Years

2025 “Mind-Skin Code: Preliminary Dance Practice”
ANTI—SPACE, Montréal

Photo Documentation of the Event



Workshop Records Over the Years

2025 “*Mind-Skin Code: From Skin to Kinship*”
Gyeonggi Museum of Modern Art, South Korea

[Audio Documentation of the Event](#)
[Photo Documentation of the Event](#)
[Event Facebookpage](#)
[Exhibition Webpage](#)

Workshop Records Over the Years

2024 “*Mind-Skin Code: Hand Readers*”
Taipei, Taiwan

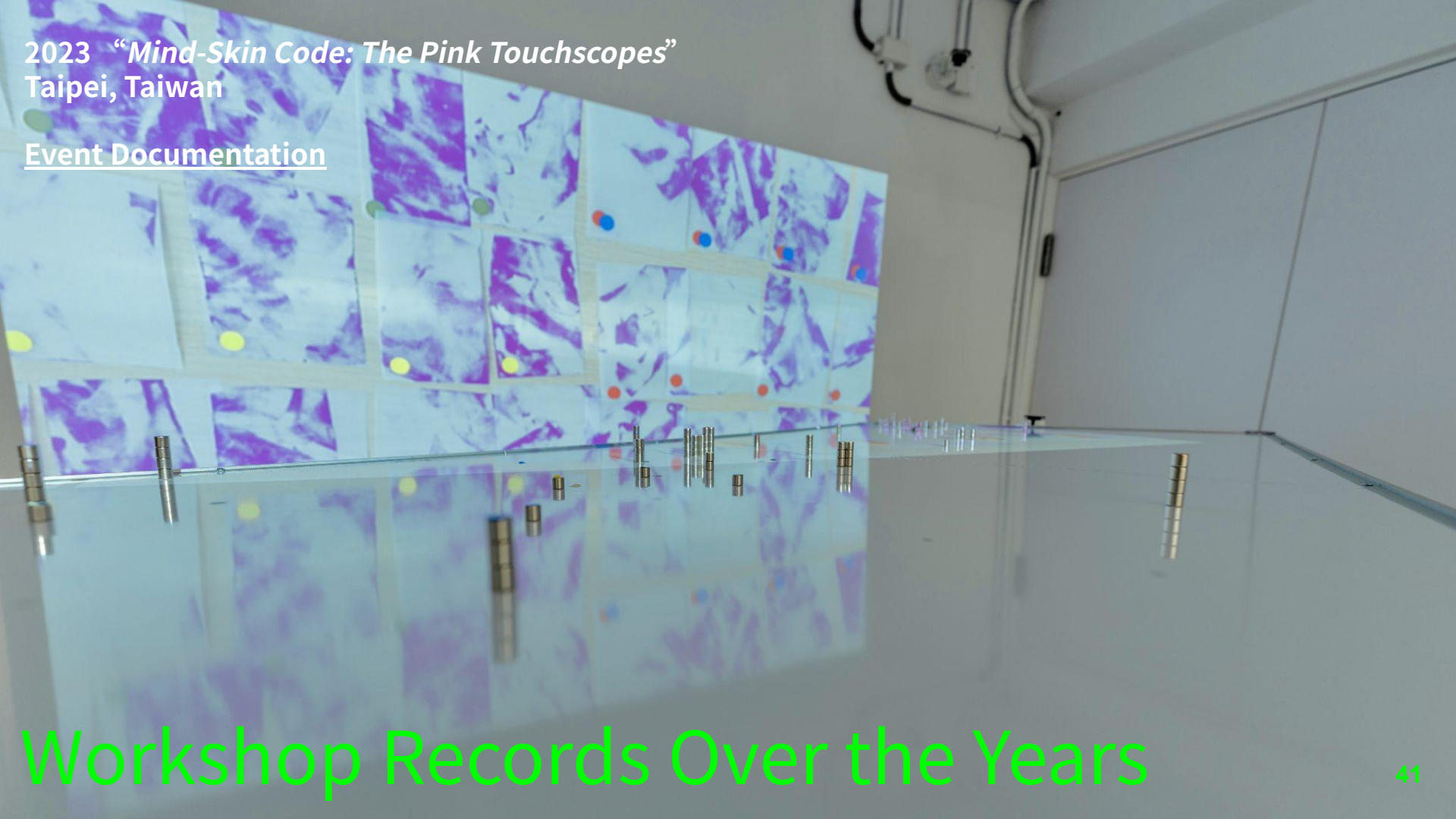
[Mandarin Audio Recording](#)
[English Audio Recording](#)
[Event Documentation](#)
[Event Webpage](#)



Workshop Records Over the Years

2023 “*Mind-Skin Code: The Pink Touchscopes*”
Taipei, Taiwan

Event Documentation



Workshop Records Over the Years

2023 “*Mind-Skin Codex: The Silent Hands*”
Pucón, Chile

Event Documentation

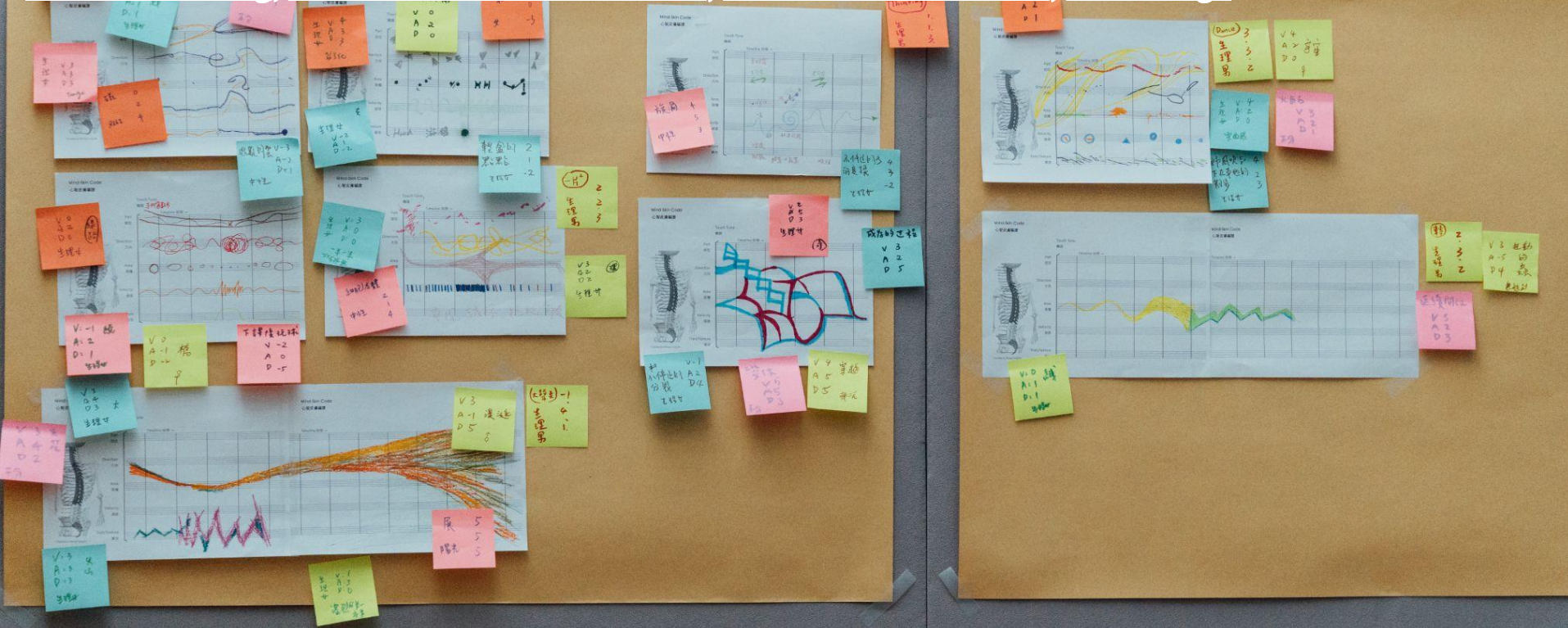


Workshop Records Over the Years

2023 “Mind-Skin Codex: On Our 36,000 Fungal Sex”

Taipei, Taiwan

Audio Recording, Event Documentation Video, Event Documentation, Event Page



Workshop Records Over the Years

Documentation Video 1, Documentation Video 2, Event Documentation



Workshop Records Over the Years

2022 “*Mind-Skin Code*” Chiang Mai, Thailand
Documentation Video, Event Documentation



Workshop Records Over the Years

謝謝閱讀。
Thank you
for reading.

